last to hold office. At other times, he has suggested that if there is to be a new Dalai Lama he could be found anywhere in the world – including, presumably, among Tibetans in India. The possibility that the next Dalai Lama would be India-born would be worrying to Chinese authorities. Delhi has remained silent on the issue of a post–Dalai Lama Tibet and the future of Tibetans on Indian soil. Yet it must think about how to deal with Tibet and Tibetan exiles after the present Dalai Lama departs the stage. If, as suggested earlier, the 1962 war was related to developments in Tibet after the rebellion of 1956, India could find itself in an awkward position.

In the meantime, Beijing seems to have stepped up its campaign in Tibet. In late August 2020, it warned against 'splittism' (separatism) in Tibet. At a Central Committee symposium on 29 August on Tibet, Xinhua reported President Xi as calling for 'continuous efforts to enhance recognition of *the great motherland, the Chinese nation, the Chinese culture*, the CPC and socialism with Chinese characteristics by people of all ethnic groups . . . Tibetan Buddhism should be guided in adapting to the socialist society and *should be developed in the Chinese context*' (emphasis added).[7] Reports suggest that Xinjiang-style re-education has begun in Tibet – military-style training for rural labour mostly – accompanied by the forced transfer of labour to other parts of Tibet or other provinces. Conditions in Tibet always colour China's view of India. Beijing has never shed the view that Delhi interferes in Tibetan affairs, and it is certain that in a post–Dalai Lama period the two countries will find themselves eyeing each other suspiciously.

Beyond India's and China's long-standing tensions over their perimeters is the question of their strategic partnerships with the Great Powers. As we saw, it is non-aligned India that has repeatedly sought alignments against China. China too has aligned with both Russia and the US, but it has done so to balance against those two powers. This pattern looks set to continue. India has drifted closer to the US in order to balance China, while China has partnered Russia to balance the US. The Ladakh crisis has accelerated Delhi's closeness to Washington. As noted earlier, India has signed three foundational military agreements with the US since 2002. The fourth and